

How we intend to work on agentic AI — and why the window is the next four quarters

01 · THE OBJECTIVE

Run the business as a **continuous decision** — and make sure that when an agent does the buying, ours is the credential it reaches for and the trust layer it relies on. One governed layer serves both halves: internally it compresses the loop from signal to committed action; externally it is the product we sell into the agent ecosystem.

02 THE BACKDROP — WHAT AGENTIC COMMERCE IS ALREADY DOING TO THIS BUSINESS

+393% AI-referred traffic to US retail, YoY Q1 2026. It converts 42% better than other traffic	~1.5% Of US e-commerce transacted on AI platforms today. Small — and 4x last year	\$190B US agentic commerce by 2030, base case (~10% of US e-comm). Bull case \$385B	3 of 4 Repricing value pools sit <i>above</i> the card — discovery, checkout, trust. The fourth is funding choice	The structural point: card economics rest partly on inertia — the customer who does not shop around and the default never re-examined. An agent removes it. Top of wallet becomes top of mandate : a credential not provisioned before the agent shops is not in the consideration set.
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03 WHAT WE ACHIEVE, AND HOW

SENSE Macro, market, regulatory, performance, servicing and fraud signals, catalogued and continuously ingested	SYNTHESISE Signals resolved into a framed situation with a causal mechanism, not a dashboard delta	GENERATE Alternatives, tradeoffs and recorded dissent, then a governed commitment with an owner and a date	GOVERN Outcome readback into the fabric, so the next decision starts where the last one finished
GOVERNANCE IS A PLANE, NOT A PEER. Model risk, consent, limits, audit and recourse cut through all four layers and feed findings back into the fabric. Spine: Signal → Synthesis → Program → Initiative → Stage / Task.			
– Strangler-fig deployment. Wrap existing systems. No rip-and-replace, no dependency on a re-platform		– Agent flag first. Agent identity carried in auth, fraud and dispute records before volume arrives	
– Machine-readable value. Rewards, offers and financing exposed as data a ranking agent can value		– Trust as a product. Registration, scoped mandates, verifiable intent, dispute attribution — built to the standard, not to one vendor	

04 WHY EXECUTIVES SHOULD CARE

1 The provisioning window closes before the volume arrives A distribution race, not a product race, decided in four quarters. There is no catch-up path once a customer's agent has a working credential set.
2 Trust is a new priced pool we are already credentialled for Issuers hold the liability, the disputes machinery and the regulator relationship. A competitor has already shipped an issuer liability commitment.
3 Every quarter without the agent flag is an unreadable quarter Decisions today are made without agent-attributed evidence — compounding measurement debt, cheap now and expensive later. And if agentic commerce stalled entirely, the decision layer still pays for itself.

05 WHAT DEFINES SUCCESS

MEASURE	READ BY
Agent-flagged coverage — share of auth, fraud and dispute records carrying agent identity	Q+1
Decision cycle & readback — median days signal-to-commitment; share of commitments with a recorded outcome	Q+1
Provisioning share — our credentials in agent permission sets vs. portfolio share	Q+2
Attribution rate — disputes resolved to agent / merchant / user with no manual work	Q+3
Partner agent-readiness — partners publishing a machine-readable catalogue	Q+3
Agent-originated spend share and its net revenue rate — the lagging measure	Q+6
Judge on the first five. Only they are observable inside twelve months. Judging on agent-originated spend in year one judges someone else's adoption curve.	

06 THE DELIVERABLES

Agent-flag instrumentation Agent identity and mandate reference carried through auth, fraud and dispute records	NOW
Decision layer, one domain Signal catalogue and the eight-element decision system live in one domain	NOW
Provisioning play A named path into agent permission sets across the network programmes	NEXT
Trust services v1 Scoped mandates, customer-set limits, registration, attribution-backed disputes	NEXT
Machine-readable value Rewards, offers and financing published as structured data	LATER

07 THE ROI AND THE SAVE — HOW WE WILL CALCULATE IT, NOT WHAT WE ARE CLAIMING YET

LEVER	CALCULATION	WHAT IT TURNS ON
Spend defended	$\frac{\text{portfolio spend} \times \text{agent share}}{\text{rate} \times \text{provisioning win rate}} \times \frac{\text{net revenue}}{\text{rate}}$	Largest, most timing-sensitive. Win rate is the only term we control — and it decays as permission sets fill.
Partner traffic held	$\frac{\text{partner sales via agent surfaces}}{\text{of tender} \times \text{net revenue rate}} \times \text{our share}$	Partner agent-readiness. We can convene it; we do not own it.
Dispute handling	$\frac{\text{disputes}}{\text{cost each} \times \text{share auto-attributable}} \times \frac{\text{accounts}}{\text{1,000 acct's}} \times \frac{\text{loaded}}{\text{accounts}}$	Needs the agent flag shipped first — which is why instrumentation is a Now deliverable.
Servicing deflection	$\frac{\text{contacts on agent-originated txns}}{\text{deflection rate} \times \text{loaded cost each}}$	The customer being able to see the mandate chain themselves. Front-end, not back-office.
Decision cycle	$\frac{\text{governed decisions}}{\text{loaded rate} \times 4} \times \frac{\text{hours saved each}}{\text{qtr}}$	Adoption of the layer, not its capability. Measured on cycle time, never effort surveys.
Trust services	$\frac{\text{enabled agent transactions}}{\text{enablement or bp on protected spend}} \times \frac{\text{price per}}{\text{enablement or bp on protected spend}}$	Modelled, not banked. Turns on liability rules settling so the service is purchasable.
What we will not claim. No headcount reduction — operations work changes shape rather than disappearing, and pretending otherwise makes the rest untrustworthy. No 2030 forecast used as a revenue input. Shaded terms are inputs to fill from portfolio data before this goes to a committee.		